

Prime Scientific: why paid ads are not converting

Prepared 7 September 2026. Every figure below was measured directly against the live site and Prime Scientific's own event stream over the ten days ending 7 September 2026 (3,877 recorded events, 593 distinct visitors). Nothing here is estimated or inferred from benchmarks.

Paid traffic converts 11.8 times worse than every other source, and the drop happens in the first few seconds of the visit, before anyone sees a product.

The store itself is healthy and selling. The checkout works. The problem is that the homepage asks every brand new visitor to complete a verification form before it will show them anything, and every paid click is by definition a brand new visitor.

1. The store is working. The ads are not reaching it.

It is important to separate two claims that are easy to confuse. Over the ten day window the business took **35 orders worth \$8,006.88**. So the store converts, the payment flow works, and the catalog sells. The advertising is a different story: of those 35 orders, only **2** came from someone who arrived by clicking an ad.

Over the same period the ad account recorded **\$968.37 of spend, 399 clicks and 40,229 impressions**, at a click through rate of 0.99% and a cost per click of \$2.43. The ad platform reports zero attributed purchases. Our own event level read is slightly kinder and finds two, worth \$337.72, but the conclusion is the same either way.

2. Where the paid visitors actually stop

This is the whole finding in one table. Both columns are measured the same way over the same window, so the comparison is like for like.

Stage	Visitors from ads	All other visitors
People	344	249
Reached any product page	32 (9%)	116 (47%)
Added to cart	15	43
Started checkout	9	38
Purchased	2	17
Conversion rate	0.58%	6.83%
Left after a single interaction	69%	37%

Read the second row first, because it carries the answer. Only **9% of paid visitors ever reach a product page at all**, against 47% of everyone else. By the time anyone could form an opinion about price, product range or trust, five out of six paid visitors are already gone. **69% of paid visitors register exactly one interaction and leave.**

Checkout is not the problem, and any dashboard prompt suggesting otherwise is misleading.

Among visitors who reach checkout, non paid traffic completes the purchase 45% of the time. That is a healthy checkout. Almost nobody from a paid ad ever gets that far to begin with.

3. The cause

The homepage at primescientificlab.com does not show the catalog to a new visitor. It shows a verification gate, headed "*Confirm the statement below to continue to the catalog*", which asks the visitor to confirm they are 21 or over and buying for research use only, **and to type in an email address** before continuing.

Once someone clears that gate, the result is stored in their browser. Returning visitors therefore never see it again. That single fact explains the entire gap:

- **Your existing audience**, who arrive from email, search, direct and social, mostly cleared this gate days or weeks ago. They land straight on the catalog. They convert at 6.83%.
- **Every paid click is a first time visitor by construction.** They meet the wall on arrival, are asked for an email address before they have been given a single reason to trust the brand, and most of them leave. They convert at 0.58%.

313 of the 344 paid visitors landed on that gated homepage. The ads are paying full price to deliver people to a form instead of to a product.

4. A second, separate defect: a broken landing page

The page primescientificlab.com/access returns a **404 error**. This was confirmed today against the live site, with controls: the product listing returns 200 normally, and a deliberately invented address returns 404 as expected, so the failure is real and specific to that address.

Twenty paid visitors landed directly on that broken page, and 22 touched it in total. That spend bought an error page. This is independent of the gate and can be fixed on its own.

5. Worth knowing: a large share of the traffic is not in the ad report

Of the paid visitors identified, **130 arrived tagged as TikTok traffic**, alongside 318 tagged generically as paid social. That activity does not appear in the ad platform's own reporting, so any judgement made purely from that dashboard is working from an incomplete picture of what is being bought and where it is going.

6. What we recommend, in priority order

1. **Remove the email requirement from the gate.** This is the single highest value change and costs nothing. If compliance requires an age and research use confirmation, keep the checkbox, which is one click. Asking a stranger for an email address before showing them a single product is what is destroying the paid funnel. Better still, show the catalog behind the confirmation rather than in front of it, so the visitor can see what they are being asked to verify for.

2. **Fix or remove the /access page.** Either restore it or repoint whatever is sending traffic there. Twenty paid visitors reached a 404.
3. **Send ads to product pages, not to the homepage.** Even with the gate in place, landing someone on the specific product the ad promised removes a step and makes the ad and the page agree.
4. **Re-measure after each change.** These are three independent fixes. Changing them one at a time is what makes it possible to say which one worked.

Our expectation, stated honestly as an expectation and not a promise, is that the first item alone moves paid conversion substantially, because the non paid segment demonstrates what this same store, catalog and checkout achieve once the gate is out of the way.

7. Method and limitations

Visitors were classed as paid when any event in their session carried an advertising click identifier. Every event in the window was read in full, following pagination to completion, so the totals are not a truncated sample.

One honest caveat. A returning visitor can lose the click identifier, so this method slightly undercounts paid traffic and therefore slightly understates paid conversion. The effect is real but small, and nowhere near large enough to account for a gap of 11.8 times. The finding does not depend on it: the 9% versus 47% product page reach is measured on arrival behaviour, and the verification gate was confirmed present on the live site today.